Hedwig's 9 PM Intelligence Report

Monday, 19 October 2026

3 Things I Absolutely Should Know Today

DeepSeek releases V4.1-Flash-1017 - free open-weights model for developers

What happened: DeepSeek launched the V4.1-Flash-1017 version of its V4 series, a high-performance language model available for free download with open weights, priced at roughly $0.20 per inference task.

Why you should care: The model can be run locally on a mid-range GPU (e.g., RTX 3060) and is suitable for experimenting with code generation, natural-language tasks, and building agentic AI prototypes without incurring cloud costs-ideal for a Diploma IT student in India looking to build portfolio projects.

Impact: Medium

Source: YouTube - OmniTech Daily

GitLab Releases Patches for Critical RCE Vulnerability (CVE-2026-97229)

What happened: GitLab issued updates for its AI Gateway (versions 19.2.4, 19.3.2, 19.4.1) to fix a high-severity remote code execution flaw that could let an authenticated user run arbitrary commands.

Why you should care: Many Indian colleges use GitLab for collaborative coding projects; unpatched servers expose student code and credentials to takeover.

Impact: Medium

Source: securityaffairs.com

Government of India launches 'YUVA AI for ALL' - free national AI course

What happened: The Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (MeitY) released a free online course titled "YUVA AI for ALL" under the IndiaAI Mission, aimed at introducing artificial intelligence concepts to Indian youth.

Why you should care: The course provides a structured, government-backed learning path covering AI fundamentals, suitable for Diploma IT students seeking to add AI knowledge without cost.

Impact: Medium

Source: Digital India

AI

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Developer World

No relevant items.

Cybersecurity

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Impact: Medium

Source: securityaffairs.com

Atlassian Warns of Critical File-Access Flaw in Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket (CVE-2026-21589)

What happened: Atlassian disclosed a vulnerability that permits arbitrary file access in self-hosted Data Center editions of Jira, Confluence and Bitbucket, requiring only knowledge of target file paths.

Why you should care: These tools are widely deployed in Indian IT labs and internships; exploitation could lead to leakage of project files, assignment data, or deployment scripts.

Impact: Medium

Source: bleepingcomputer.com

India

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Impact: Medium

Source: Digital India

IndiaAI Innovation Challenge 2024 - national AI competition

What happened: The Software Technology Parks of India (STPI) announced the IndiaAI Innovation Challenge 2024, a competition encouraging startups and students to develop AI solutions aligned with the IndiaAI Mission's goals of ethical, responsible AI and societal impact.

Why you should care: Participation offers Diploma IT students hands-on experience, networking with industry mentors, and potential access to funding or incubation through STPI's investor connections.

Impact: Medium

Source: STPI

Learn

Free 10-Hour AI Course with Certificate - AI Skills Passport by Microsoft & EY

What happened: Microsoft and EY launched a free, approximately 10-hour artificial-intelligence course that awards a certificate on completion.

Why you should care: The curriculum covers core AI concepts and hands-on tools useful for diploma-level IT projects and campus placements, and the certificate adds a recognised credential to your resume.

Impact: Medium

Source: YouTube - Sakshi Mutha

Free Udemy Courses for First-Year Engineering Students

What happened: A curated list of free Udemy courses targeting essential technical skills-such as programming, data structures, and software tools-has been shared for first-year engineering students.

Why you should care: These courses provide immediate, practical learning resources without cost, helping you build a strong foundation for later semesters and internship interviews.

Impact: Medium

Source: YouTube - Dinesh Sir Counseling

Opportunities

No relevant items.

Events Near You

No in-person tech events found in Gandhinagar, Ahmedabad, or GIFT City.

Tools Worth Trying

No relevant items.

Tech Outside AI

Nvidia Launches Open Agent Safety Platform

What happened: Nvidia introduced the Open Agent Safety Platform, a containment system that acts like a "browser for agents," restricting AI agents to only the resources they need and preventing sandbox breakouts.

Why you should care: Understanding AI safety frameworks is increasingly important for IT students, and the platform's open-source nature offers a real-world example to study for coursework on AI security and system design.

Impact: Medium

Source: CNBC

Microsoft Unveils All-In-One Copilot App

What happened: Microsoft released an integrated Copilot application that combines AI assistance with full versions of Word, Excel, and PowerPoint, allowing users to create and edit documents within a single AI-driven interface.

Why you should care: The app showcases practical AI integration into everyday productivity tools, providing a hands-on example for students learning about AI-enhanced software development and enterprise solutions.

Impact: Medium

Source: GeekWire

My Action for Tomorrow

Download and install the DeepSeek V4.1-Flash-1017 model on a local GPU, then run a simple code-generation prompt to evaluate its suitability for your upcoming project.

If You Only Remember 3 Things

- DeepSeek's free V4.1-Flash-1017 model enables low-cost AI experimentation on a mid-range GPU.
- Patch GitLab AI Gateway immediately to protect collaborative student projects from remote code execution.
- Enroll in the government-backed "YUVA AI for ALL" course for structured, cost-free AI education.